

GENERATION PROMPT SHEET

The eight shots in the 3:00 animatic that came out of a generator rather than a camera. All eight are in the cut; each still wears a red GENERATE tag so it is never mistaken for footage we own. The pages that follow carry the exact string that made each one, house look included, ready to paste.

To re-roll one: `tools/video/generate.py --only <slug> --force`. Nothing else in the cut moves. Deliver 16:9, 1920x1080, 30fps, no audio, longer than the slot with handles at both ends – every one of these is cut to the frame against a score that cannot be trimmed. Veo makes that automatic: at 1080p it only produces 8-second clips, longer than every slot here.

Veo 3.x has no negative prompt field, so the avoid-list is folded into each prompt as properties the image has. For Runway or Kling, which do take negatives, the separate list is in `docs/generation-prompts.md`.

THE EIGHT

YOU-HAVE-USED-TOO-MUCH-POWER	0:00-0:06	3.0s	vibe 5-6	YOU HAVE USED TOO MUCH POWER	IN THE CUT
THEIR-POWER-WAS-CUT	0:36-0:40	3.5s	vibe 10-11	THEIR POWER WAS CUT	IN THE CUT
RITUAL	0:45.9-0:52.9	7.0s	vibe 15-22	ZVEN RITUAL – SOURCE NEEDED	IN THE CUT
METER	1:22.1-1:25.1	3.0s	vibe 77-78	THE METER IN THE DOORWAY	IN THE CUT
INSPECTORS	1:38.1-1:43.1	4.5s	vibe 71-76	1 – WELLNESS INSPECTORS ARRIVE	IN THE CUT
DARK	1:52.3-1:58.3	6.0s	vibe 25-63	5 – DANCING IN THE DARK	IN THE CUT
POWER	1:58.3-2:01.3	3.5s	vibe 63-26	THEY CUT THE POWER	IN THE CUT
AFTERMATH	2:19.4-2:24.4	5.0s	vibe 0-54	3 – THE AFTERMATH	IN THE CUT

YOU HAVE USED TOO MUCH POWER

The conflict before the film has a hero, stated in words a child can read off the wall. Not a safety measure – a bill. The great thing was achieved, the account was closed, and what is left is a world charged for what a finished world costs. The same two words come back at 2:46 as the machine's own reading.

PROMPT – paste this, ask for 8 seconds

Static macro, filling the frame, on the amber LCD of a wall-mounted domestic utility panel in a dark empty hallway at night. The display shows two lines of blocky dot-matrix text. The first line, large and centred, reads: YOU HAVE USED TOO MUCH POWER. Beneath it, in smaller text, a second line reads: NEW LIMIT: WHAT A FINISHED WORLD NEEDS. Both lines stay on screen for the whole shot. A relay clicks and the hallway lights step down one level. No people, no camera move. Available light, heavy grain, near-monochrome with only the amber display in colour. Shot on a degraded consumer camera: heavy film grain, soft crushed blacks, halation around any bright source, slightly soft focus, slightly underexposed. Almost entirely monochrome – colour appears only where named above. Available light only, no film lighting. The camera is locked off on a tripod or handheld by someone standing still; it does not travel. Everything in frame is worn and ordinary: concrete, steel, chipped paint, cheap fabric. Observational documentary footage, nobody aware of the camera, nobody posing. Real unglamorous people. No text, captions, logos or watermarks anywhere in frame. No uniforms, no police, no military, no weapons.

THEIR POWER WAS CUT

The inciting incident, and it is a bill. Racks powering down mid-run, work abandoned in place. What follows is not mysticism, it is the same experiment run on the only supply nobody is charging for. V.O.: "We have no power. So we have no machines."

PROMPT – paste this, ask for 8 seconds

Interior of a small cluttered laboratory at night. A rack of computers powers down row by row, cooling fans winding to silence, status LEDs going out one bank at a time until only emergency lighting is left. Papers and coffee cups abandoned mid-work on the bench. No people in frame. Locked-off static wide, no camera move. Available light, heavy grain, near-monochrome, the last LEDs the only colour. Shot on a degraded consumer camera: heavy film grain, soft crushed blacks, halation around any bright source, slightly soft focus, slightly underexposed. Almost entirely monochrome – colour appears only where named above. Available light only, no film lighting. The camera is locked off on a tripod or handheld by someone standing still; it does not travel. Everything in frame is worn and ordinary: concrete, steel, chipped paint, cheap fabric. Observational documentary footage, nobody aware of the camera, nobody posing. Real unglamorous people. No text, captions, logos or watermarks anywhere in frame. No uniforms, no police, no military, no weapons.

ZVEN RITUAL — SOURCE NEEDED

The meditation circle with the crossed blue beams is the most credible image in the film and the contest cut contains 1.9 SECONDS of it (16.0–17.9). This act wants thirty. Candles, beams, the circle, biosensor headbands going on. The beams have to leave the structure – that is the moonshot, and without it the act is a séance instead of a transmission. Highest-value missing asset by a distance; if the source is gone, rebuild around the aftermath shot and sensor inserts.

PROMPT – paste this, ask for 8 seconds

ONLY IF THE SOURCE IS UNRECOVERABLE – find it first. Twenty people seated cross-legged on floor cushions in a circle around a cluster of candles, inside a temporary tabernacle built of raw pine framing and silver mylar sheeting, faceted into an octagonal chamber and erected inside a larger dark hall. Two crossed blue laser beams overhead, EEG headbands being fitted. Very slow push-in. Then a matching exterior: the same two blue beams leaving the roof of the structure into a clear night sky and converging on the moon. Near-monochrome except the blue beams and the candle flames. Heavy grain, available light. Shot on a degraded consumer camera: heavy film grain, soft crushed blacks, halation around any bright source, slightly soft focus, slightly underexposed. Almost entirely monochrome – colour appears only where named above. Available light only, no film lighting. The camera is locked off on a tripod or handheld by someone standing still; it does not travel. Everything in frame is worn and ordinary: concrete, steel, chipped paint, cheap fabric. Observational documentary footage, nobody aware of the camera, nobody posing. Real unglamorous people. No text, captions, logos or watermarks anywhere in frame. No uniforms, no police, no military, no weapons.

THE METER IN THE DOORWAY

The measurement arriving before the enforcement. Nobody reacts to it – the party does not know it is being assessed, which is the point.

PROMPT – paste this, ask for 8 seconds

A calibrated sound-level meter held at arm's length in a raw timber doorway, red LED reading 96.4 dB, the interior of a candlelit tabernacle of pine framing and silver mylar strobing out of focus behind it. The hand is steady and unhurried, a lanyard swings at the wrist. Shallow depth – the meter sharp, the celebration soft. Night, available light, heavy grain, near-monochrome. Shot on a degraded consumer camera: heavy film grain, soft crushed blacks, halation around any bright source, slightly soft focus, slightly underexposed. Almost entirely monochrome – colour appears only where named above. Available light only, no film lighting. The camera is locked off on a tripod or handheld by someone standing still; it does not travel. Everything in frame is worn and ordinary: concrete, steel, chipped paint, cheap fabric. Observational documentary footage, nobody aware of the camera, nobody posing. Real unglamorous people. The only text anywhere in frame is the readout described above, in its own display, correctly spelled and sharp enough to read. No captions, subtitles, logos or watermarks.

1 — WELLNESS INSPECTORS ARRIVE

The field staff, not the author. Unhurried, kind, no uniforms and no weapons – cut 2–3s against Act III's 0.5s so the calm itself is the intrusion.

PROMPT – paste this, ask for 8 seconds

Three or four people in soft sage-green softshell jackets with ID lanyards duck through a low timber doorway and walk calmly into a hazy candlelit tabernacle of raw pine framing and silver mylar sheeting at night, carrying clipboards and a handheld sound meter. One smiles and offers a bottle of water to a dancer. No uniforms, no weapons, no urgency. Handheld, available light, heavy grain, near-monochrome, slow walk-in. Shot on a degraded consumer camera: heavy film grain, soft crushed blacks, halation around any bright source, slightly soft focus, slightly underexposed. Almost entirely monochrome – colour appears only where named above. Available light only, no film lighting. The camera is locked off on a tripod or handheld by someone standing still; it does not travel. Everything in frame is worn and ordinary: concrete, steel, chipped paint, cheap fabric. Observational documentary footage, nobody aware of the camera, nobody posing. Real unglamorous people. No text, captions, logos or watermarks anywhere in frame.

5 — DANCING IN THE DARK

Runs the reversal exactly: 25 up to 63. The low end comes back with it and so does the colour. The hope beat, immediately before the kill.

PROMPT – paste this, ask for 8 seconds

A dense crowd dancing hard in near-total darkness inside a timber-framed chamber hung with silver mylar, lit only by one or two phone torches sweeping across faces, raised arms and the sheeting. Bodies read as silhouettes and brief flashes. Extreme grain, almost monochrome, handheld at chest height inside the crowd. Energy building through the shot. Shot on a degraded consumer camera: heavy film grain, soft crushed blacks, halation around any bright source, slightly soft focus, slightly underexposed. Almost entirely monochrome – colour appears only where named above. Available light only, no film lighting. The camera is locked off on a tripod or handheld by someone standing still; it does not travel. Everything in frame is worn and ordinary: concrete, steel, chipped paint, cheap fabric. Observational documentary footage, nobody aware of the camera, nobody posing. Real unglamorous people. No text, captions, logos or watermarks anywhere in frame. No uniforms, no police, no military, no weapons.

THEY CUT THE POWER

63 down to 26 in three and a half seconds – the steepest fall in the film. Not the caps this time: the meter stopped agreeing with them, so the room stops existing, and the picture starts corrupting on this frame and not one before.

PROMPT – paste this, ask for 8 seconds

An electrical intake cupboard on the wall of a dark hall, beside a temporary structure of raw pine framing and silver mylar, its steel door open on a bank of breakers. A gloved hand in a sage-green sleeve takes the main breaker and pulls it down. In the same frame the hall and the lit structure beyond drop to black; music and light die together. Single static wide, no cut, no camera move. Available light before, near-total darkness after. Heavy grain, near-monochrome. Shot on a degraded consumer camera: heavy film grain, soft crushed blacks, halation around any bright source, slightly soft focus, slightly underexposed. Almost entirely monochrome – colour appears only where named above. Available light only, no film lighting. The camera is locked off on a tripod or handheld by someone standing still; it does not travel. Everything in frame is worn and ordinary: concrete, steel, chipped paint, cheap fabric. Observational documentary footage, nobody aware of the camera, nobody posing. Real unglamorous people. No text, captions, logos or watermarks anywhere in frame.

3 — THE AFTERMATH

Hold longer than is comfortable. The telemetry sits at absolute zero for ten seconds here and the score is silent for all of it. THE NOTHING.

PROMPT – paste this, ask for 8 seconds

Static wide of an emptied tabernacle at dawn – an octagonal chamber of raw pine framing hung with silver mylar sheeting, erected inside a larger dark hall. Candles burned out and smoking, floor cushions stacked against a timber strut, house fluorescents up hard, nobody there. No movement at all except one thread of candle smoke. Cold flat light, heavy grain, near-monochrome. Locked off, no cut. Shot on a degraded consumer camera: heavy film grain, soft crushed blacks, halation around any bright source, slightly soft focus, slightly underexposed. Almost entirely monochrome – colour appears only where named above. Available light only, no film lighting. The camera is locked off on a tripod or handheld by someone standing still; it does not travel. Everything in frame is worn and ordinary: concrete, steel, chipped paint, cheap fabric. Observational documentary footage, nobody aware of the camera, nobody posing. Real unglamorous people. No text, captions, logos or watermarks anywhere in frame. No uniforms, no police, no military, no weapons.